

Cyberbullying: A Case Study on Digital Harassment

Cyberbullying is a type of online harassment in which victims are repeatedly singled out via digital channels like email, messaging apps, and social media. It frequently entails sending abusive messages, disseminating rumors, and publishing damaging content.

A real-world example is the numerous instances of severe cyberbullying that students in India experienced on social media sites like Facebook and WhatsApp. A teenage girl was the victim of one such instance when her friends altered her pictures and posted them online with her phone number. This resulted in abusive calls, ongoing harassment, and public humiliation. Cyberbullying usually starts when the bully finds a target, usually someone who is socially isolated or vulnerable. The bully might fabricate profiles or misuse private information, like pictures. Next, offensive or embarrassing material is shared among groups or made public. This is followed by persistent harassment via calls, messages, or remarks, which exacerbates the victim's emotional suffering.

Cyberbullying frequently targets young adults, college students, and teenagers who use social media. Anxiety, depression, low self-esteem, and in severe situations, self-harm or suicide, are just a few of the dire repercussions. Research demonstrates that cyberbullying significantly impairs students' mental health and wellbeing.

In order to create a safer online environment, this case emphasizes the significance of responsible online behavior, awareness, and strong action against digital harassment.